

Let There be 2008

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We interrupt the adverts to bring you the gaming report for 2008: platform exclusives are thin, the Xbox 360's rolling thunder continues to gain momentum, third-parties continue to miss the Wii wave, and the PS3 is coming back in style and in force. And now, back to our sponsors...

Devil May Cry 4

Feb 2008

Hack and slash, Action

PS3 X360, PC

After the demon-ass kicking prequel that was *Devil May Cry 3*, Capcom is bringing back the franchise with a sequel. Ass kicking, now in glorious HD, comes to the next-generation consoles and the PC. In *DMC4*, a new character called Nero is being introduced. Also joining Dante is a female character called Kylie. While Dante from previous games would also be playable in *DMC4*, the main protagonist is hinted as being Nero this time around.

The game will feature the same insane combat and enemies of the previous iterations as also the over-the-top dialogues and cut-scenes. The game's difficulty would be tweaked in this outing, however, as Producer Hiroyuki Kobayashi has made changes to the gameplay so that controlling characters is less difficult. The game will, in general, have a more forgiving

learning curve—it will start off easier but will ramp up in difficulty as the player progresses, eventually surpassing *DMC3*'s difficulty.

New combat elements will be added thanks to Nero's devil arm and his "Devil Bringer" Power. The arm, for example, would be used to pull in and push out opponents during combat, trigger special moves, or even travel short distances. Dante, the primary character in the rest of the series, will also be playable, and will have updated versions of the core animations used in *Devil May Cry 3: Dante's Awakening*, as well as that game's four basic fighting styles: Trickster, Royal Guard, Gunslinger, and Sword Master, which can be switched at will.

This game is Rajnikanth approved! You dare not miss it!

Army of Two

March 2008

Third Person Shooter

PS3 X360

Co-operative action and gameplay seems to be the focus of this third-person game from EA. Unlike most games in the past which have an option for co-op, *Army of Two* has been designed to *only* be playable in a pair. The second player can either be controlled by a friend or by the game's AI. The co-op action takes a range of activities: a player can boost another up a wall, the second player can then pull the first one up, one can hold a rope while the other ripples down a wall, or both can cover each other's back and shoot at the enemies; two players will also be required to man the vehicles—one drives while the other shoots, and so on. The developers have also borrowed a book from popular MMORPG titles and introduced an "aggro" system via an "Aggrometer". Aggro measures the aggressiveness that the enemies feel towards the game's characters. The idea is for one of the characters to rake in the aggro—this makes the other character less visible to the enemy and the other can then take them down in stealth. The game will also allow a great deal of customisation for the weapons which include: changing stocks, adding silencers, grip handles, extra-large magazines,

2007 was a joygasm for anyone remotely into gaming. The consoles shone bright, the PC returned with a bang... or three, and the world seemed less slightly cruel. What glories does 2008 have in store? Read on to find out!

